

Word Ladders

Change ONE letter each step — grades 4-6

Name _____

Date _____

Start at the top word. Change **one letter** on each step to make a new real word, until you reach the bottom word.

Ladder 1

S	C	O	U	T
S	P	A	R	K

Ladder 2

S	N	A	K	E
S	P	I	N	E

Ladder 3

P	L	A	N	T
S	T	O	C	K

Ladder 4

S	H	E	L	F
S	T	A	T	E

Word Ladders

Answer Key

Sample answers. Any ladder is correct if every step changes just one letter and makes a real word.

Ladder 1

S	C	O	U	T
S	H	O	U	T
S	H	O	R	T
S	H	O	R	E
S	H	A	R	E
S	H	A	R	K
S	P	A	R	K

Ladder 2

S	N	A	K	E
S	H	A	K	E
S	H	A	D	E
S	P	A	D	E
S	P	A	C	E
S	P	I	C	E
S	P	I	N	E

Ladder 3

P	L	A	N	T
P	L	A	N	K
B	L	A	N	K
B	L	A	C	K
S	L	A	C	K
S	T	A	C	K
S	T	O	C	K

Ladder 4

S	H	E	L	F
S	H	E	L	L
S	M	E	L	L
S	M	A	L	L
S	T	A	L	L
S	T	A	L	E
S	T	A	T	E